Finance Operations platform: synopsis

What it is

A working prototype that takes on the keying and ticking in finance operations, checks its own work, and sends a person only what it isn't sure of. It is built around one rule: nothing is approved, paid or released without a named person, and a wrong number should never pass quietly.

What it can do today

Statement spreading (the core). It reads a company's financial statements from an SEC filing, a PDF with a text layer or an Excel workbook, and places each number on a standard template.

- Every number links back to the printed cell it came from.
- Accounting checks run on the result. A value goes through without review only if independent evidence agrees with it, such as a check that adds up, the same number repeated in the filing, last year's approved spread, or a label's track record.
- Blockers and warnings open to show what is wrong, why it matters, the printed statement with the row marked, suggested fixes, and a place to fix it with a recorded reason.
- Spreads export to Excel, CSV and JSON.
- Each company's approved spreads and each person's corrections feed later documents.

Reconciliation. Matches bank lines to the ledger. Only unambiguous matches settle alone; the rest are proposed to a person, and exceptions are closed with a recorded decision.

Invoices. Reads invoices, checks the arithmetic, matches them to purchase orders and receipts, and screens for duplicates and changed bank details. The best status it can give is "eligible for approval": approval and payment stay in the ERP.

Data quality. Checks vendor and purchase-order exports before another system loads them. Definite errors are rejected and suspicious records are held for a person.

Spreadsheets. Scans workbooks for broken references, inconsistent formulas, typed-over numbers and risky changes between versions. It only reads the workbook.

Results for management. Accuracy is reported in plain language. Time saved covers hours, cash, costs and what-if scenarios, with every figure labelled as measured, estimated or an assumption. Review time is recorded in the background, and only managers and admins see time and ROI figures.

Controls. Named sign-in with roles, optional two-person approval, and an audit log built to reveal later edits. An optional AI second opinion runs in shadow during a learning period, with senior reviewers ruling on disagreements.

How well it works

Measured on real SEC filings only, against each filing's own XBRL tags, a separate route to the numbers.

Unseen test. 101 filings from companies drawn at random by industry and size, kept out of tuning:

Measure	Before this round	Now
Numbers right	74.8%	81.5%
Wrong with no flag	6 of 1,574	6 of 1,762
Blank with no flag	707 of 10,037	502 of 10,019
Right with no person involved	15.6%	17.5%

The test set was opened more than once while fixing a bug, so it is close to unseen rather than perfectly unseen. In all, 327 real filings have been used. The original 54 kept-back filings were used to find fixes, so they are now a regression check.

Most numbers still go to a person, and some come out blank, so it speeds up review rather than replacing it. Results come from public filings, not private-company documents, and reconciliation and invoice rates come from generated test records.

End goal

A platform a bank, lender or finance team can trust across thousands of companies: it does the repetitive reading, matching and checking; it can prove every number; it lets through a steadily growing share of work on its own while keeping silent errors under 0.2%; and it leaves people the judgment calls. Next steps toward that are wider testing on real filings and a pilot on an organisation's own documents, with timed work to measure the real return.